

Stripe Express Country Checklist

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A 1-page reference for Medium writers worldwide setting up Partner Program payouts via Stripe Express.

Prerequisites Before Onboarding

- ☐ You are an active paying Medium member (\$5/mo or \$50/yr Member tier minimum)
- ☐ You are 18 years or older
- ☐ You have published at least 6 stories on Medium
- ☐ Your account is at least 3 months old
- ☐ You live in a country where Stripe Express is supported (see below)
- ☐ You have a bank account in your legal name in the country of residence

Supported Regions Summary (100+ Countries Post-2024 Expansion)

Region	Sample Countries	Notes
North America	US, Canada, Mexico	US writers complete W-9; non-US writers complete W-8BEN
Europe	UK, Germany, France, Spain, Italy, Netherlands, Sweden, Norway, Switzerland, Iceland, most EU	VAT not collected by Medium; declare locally
Asia	India, Indonesia, Philippines, Malaysia, Vietnam, Bangladesh, Pakistan, Thailand, Singapore, Japan	Local-currency payouts in some markets
Africa	Nigeria, Kenya, South Africa, Egypt, Ghana, Morocco	USD payouts default; verify bank acceptance
Latin America	Brazil, Mexico, Argentina, Colombia, Chile, Peru	Some countries support local currency

Region	Sample Countries	Notes
Oceania	Australia, New Zealand	Standard onboarding

Canonical, always-current list: <https://stripe.com/global>

Tax Documents By Region

- **US writers:** W-9 form. Income reported via 1099 if you cross \$600 in a year.
- **Non-US writers:** W-8BEN form. Reduces US withholding from 30% to your country's treaty rate (often 0-15%).
- **EU writers:** No VAT collection by Medium. Declare as personal/freelance income locally. VAT registration may apply above local thresholds (~€10K-€50K).
- **All other regions:** Declare Medium earnings as personal income per your local tax rules. Keep a monthly earnings log for filing.

Quick Wins For First-Time Setup

- ☐ Use a bank account in your legal name (joint accounts often fail)
- ☐ Have your government ID ready (passport or national ID)
- ☐ Set up Stripe Express in a single sitting — partial completions can lock for 24 hours
- ☐ If your bank rejects deposits: try a fintech wallet (Wise multi-currency, Revolut)
- ☐ Verify your tax form selection BEFORE submitting — corrections are slow

If You Get Rejected

1. Wait 30 days before reapplying (cooldown is automatic)
2. During the wait: improve your weakest 2 stories, complete profile gaps, ensure paying-member status is uninterrupted
3. Reapplication uses the same form — submit fresh

From Medium Income 2026 (jrdevhub.com / gumroad.com/zerix1).